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Centre for Household Finance
Department of Economics

CENTRE FOR HOUSEHOLD FINANCE

Brand & Document Guidelines

Producing documents and slides consistent with the Centre’s identity and the Stellenbosch University corporate identity

Version 1.2 · July 2026 · Department of Economics, Stellenbosch University

1. The Centre’s brand in brief

The Centre for Household Finance (CHF) is a research centre in the Department of Economics at Stellenbosch University (SU). Its identity is a **sub-brand of SU**: everything the Centre publishes should read, at a glance, as Stellenbosch University work.

The Centre does not have a standalone logo. It uses the official **co-branded lockup** supplied by SU Corporate Communication — the SU brandmark and wordmark alongside the “Centre for Household Finance / Department of Economics” descriptor. The Centre’s palette and typography are SU’s. These guidelines simply set out how to apply that identity consistently across letters, reports, slides, and web pages.

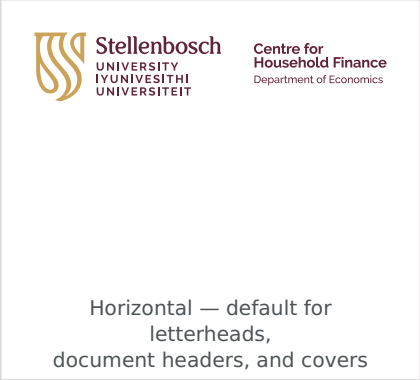
Three principles

Principle	What it means in practice
SU first	Use the SU co-branded logo, Confident Maroon, Brilliant Gold, and SU Raleway. Never create an alternative CHF logo, colour, or typeface.
Maroon leads	Confident Maroon is SU’s dominant colour and the Centre’s default field — used for headers, footers, title bands, and section blocks (SU colourway 1; primary ratio 70% maroon). Gold is the accent; white and clear typography keep it legible.
Consistency	Every outward-facing document uses the same letterhead, palette, type, and contact block, so the Centre looks like one coherent voice.

> **Authoritative source.** Where these guidelines are silent, follow the **Stellenbosch University Brand Manual** (Corporate Communication and Marketing, November 2025). The SU manual governs; this document applies it to the Centre. Every colour value, minimum size, and clear-space rule below is taken from it — section numbers are cited so you can check.

2. The logo

Always use the supplied co-branded artwork. Choose the orientation that fits the space and the colourway that gives the cleanest contrast on the background. SU calls these orientations *horizontal* and *portrait*; the supplied CHF files are named *horizontal*, *stacked*, and *vertical*.



Horizontal — default for letterheads, document headers, and covers



Stacked — for narrow or square spaces



White / gold — for maroon, dark, or dark image backgrounds

CLEAR SPACE

Keep clear space around the logo equal to **twice the height of the capital "S" in "Stellenbosch"**. Nothing — text, rules, images, page edges — should intrude on that zone. In exceptional cases half of this is permitted. (SU 4.1.4; the same rule applies to the co-branded lockup.)

MINIMUM SIZE

Horizontal lockup: no smaller than **50 mm wide** in print, or **142 px** on screen. Stacked lockup: no smaller than **30 mm high** in print, or **85 px** high on screen. (SU 4.1.4, brand-signature minimums.)

COLOURWAYS

Gold-and-maroon on white, light backgrounds, and light images; gold-and-white on maroon, dark backgrounds, and dark images — check the logo does not disappear into the image. All-black or all-white only where the entire artwork is produced in a single colour. (SU 4.1.5.)

FILE FORMATS

SVG or EPS for professionally designed work; JPG, PNG, or SVG for Microsoft Office and digital use. Vector (SVG, PDF) for print. All are supplied in the branding folder. (SU 4.1.3.)

DO

- Use the artwork exactly as supplied
- Preserve its proportions when resizing (lock aspect ratio)
- Give it generous clear space
- Place it **top-left or bottom-left**, on a clean background (SU 4.1.7)

DON'T

- Stretch, squash, rotate, or recolour it
- Add effects — shadows, outlines, gradients
- Fade or tint it, or scale its elements separately
- Recreate or typeset "Centre for Household Finance" as your own logo
- Place it on a busy background or clashing colour

3. Colour

Confident Maroon is SU's primary, most recognisable asset and the Centre's lead colour; Brilliant Gold adds warmth and signals excellence. Use them deliberately: maroon for headings and structure, gold as a thin accent (rules, key lines), and white for breathing room. Maroon is the **dominant** colour and belongs on large fields too — page and site headers, footers, title bands, and section blocks (SU colourway 1; 70% primary ratio). SU's neutrals carry body text and table fills. **These are SU's colours, under SU's names — the Centre does not define its own.**

Confident Maroon — primary
HEX #61223B
RGB 97 34 59
CMYK 15 96 31 55
Pantone 209 C
Vinyl Dark Burgundy 863

Brilliant Gold — accent
HEX #CAA258
RGB 202 162 88
CMYK 26 40 73 3
Pantone 465 C
Metallic Pantone 871 C *

Black — body text
HEX #2C2A29
RGB 44 42 41
CMYK 0 0 0 100
Pantone Process Black
Body copy is set at 80–100% black.

Steel Grey — neutral
HEX #4D5356
RGB 77 83 86
CMYK 0 0 0 80
Pantone 445 C
Captions, footers, metadata.

10% Confident Maroon — fills
HEX #EFE9EB
A tint, not a separate colour. Table stripes, callout backgrounds. SU sanctions tints of 10, 20, 40, and 60% only.

> **On the gold.** Brilliant Gold is an SU primary colour, not a CHF one. Its CMYK build is `26 / 40 / 73 / 3` — matching both the SU manual (4.2.1) and the supplied CMYK artwork. Earlier CHF drafts printed `20 / 35 / 72 / 3`; that value was wrong. SU's secondary and faculty palettes (4.2.2, 4.2.3) exist for projects that need more range — draw on them from the SU manual, not from memory.

Colour ratios

SU defines two ratios. Which one applies to a research centre is a judgement call; pick one per project and stay with it.

Ratio	Composition	SU says it is for
Primary	70% Confident Maroon · 20% Brilliant Gold · 10% secondary colours	"PASS divisions and sub-brands"
Faculty	60% Confident Maroon · 10% Brilliant Gold · 30% faculty colour Economic and Management Sciences — Pantone 319 C, #2CCCD3	"faculty-specific communication material"

SU notes these charts "should not be interpreted literally" — they express the relative importance of each colour, not a page-area measurement. In practice, for CHF documents: maroon carries the structural, high-visibility elements — headers, footers, title fields, section bands, and the logo lockup — with gold reserved for thin rules

and fine accents. Gold is never used for body text; maroon body text is avoided except for short emphasised lead-ins.

* The SU manual gives Brilliant Gold’s metallic Pantone as **871 C** in the primary-colour specification (4.2.1, p30) and as **872 C** on the logo colour-values page (4.1.2, p21). The value above follows the colour specification. Confirm with branding@sun.ac.za before any metallic print run.

4. Typography

SU's primary typeface is **SU Raleway**. Use it for everything. It is not the same as the Raleway on Google Fonts — in SU Raleway the numerals align on the baseline, and SU asks that you use the licensed family. Where it is not installed — a shared machine, an emailed editable file — fall back to **Trebuchet**, SU's designated alternate system font (4.3.3). Never substitute a serif or a decorative font. **Disable ligatures** when typesetting SU Raleway (4.3.2).

Role	Font & weight	Size & setting
Document title	SU Raleway Bold	24–28 pt, maroon, title case
Heading 1 (section)	SU Raleway Bold	15 pt, maroon, thin gold rule beneath
Heading 2 (sub-section)	SU Raleway SemiBold	12.5 pt, maroon
Body text	SU Raleway Regular or Medium	10.5 pt, leading 10.5–12.5 pt, SU Black
Lead-in / emphasis	SU Raleway Bold	inline, SU Black or maroon
Captions, footer, metadata	SU Raleway Regular	7.5–8.5 pt, Steel Grey
Reversed out of maroon	One weight heavier	white, to hold legibility

> **On leading.** SU's rule is that leading equals the point size, or sits up to 2 points above it (4.3.2) — so 10.5 pt body text takes 10.5–12.5 pt of leading, not the 1.4–1.5 line spacing earlier CHF drafts specified. Use the top of SU's range for long-form reading.

DO

- Set body text left-aligned or justified, SU Black on white
- Use SU Raleway Bold and above for headlines; SemiBold and below for subheadings; Medium and below for body
- Use one clear heading hierarchy (H1 → H2 → body)
- Keep line length comfortable (single column, ~25 mm margins)

DON'T

- Substitute Google Fonts Raleway for SU Raleway
- Leave ligatures switched on
- Mix in extra fonts, or use all-caps for long runs of text
- Set body text in maroon, gold, or light grey
- Rely on colour alone to signal a heading — use weight and size too

5. Documents & letters

Use the supplied **letter template** and **report/charter template** as the starting point for outward-facing documents. Their anatomy is standard across the Centre:

Page & letterhead

- **Page:** A4, portrait, margins ~25 mm top / 25 mm sides.
- **Header:** co-branded horizontal logo, top-left, **50–65 mm wide** (SU's minimum is 50 mm), with a thin gold rule beneath.
- **Footer:** a maroon hairline above the standard contact block (see below), plus page number on multi-page documents.
- **Headings:** maroon SU Raleway Bold; section headings carry a thin gold underline.
- **Tables:** maroon header row with white text; alternating 10% maroon tint rows; light grey cell borders.

Standard contact block (footer)

Centre for Household Finance · Department of Economics · Stellenbosch University
CGW Schumann Building, Bosman Street, Stellenbosch 7600 · Private Bag X1, Stellenbosch 7599, South Africa
+27 (0)21 808 2247 · econ@sun.ac.za · www.ekon.sun.ac.za

The publication disclaimer

Under the Centre's Research Charter (§7.2), every author-attributed output carries this line, and acknowledges the Centre's support. Include it in reports, working papers, briefs, and slide decks:

> *"The views expressed are those of the author(s) and do not represent the Centre for Household Finance, the Department of Economics, or Stellenbosch University."*

File naming

Use a consistent, sortable pattern: `CHF-[DocType]-[ShortTitle]-vX.Y.docx` — for example `CHF-Letter-DataAgreement-v1.0.docx`. Keep version numbers on governance and published documents.

6. Slides & presentations

Presentations follow the same palette and type. Build decks in **16:9**. Use a maroon title slide and clean white content slides — not maroon on every slide.

Household debt & financial resilience

Centre for Household Finance · July 2026

Title slide — maroon field, gold bar, white/gold logo

Key findings

- White background, SU Black text
- Maroon heading with a gold underline
- Charts use maroon → gold → steel grey
- One idea per slide

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Content slide — white field, maroon/gold accents

Element	Convention
Title slide	Maroon background, white/gold logo, gold accent bar, title in white SU Raleway Bold, subtitle in a light tint.
Content slides	White background, maroon heading with a thin gold underline, SU Black body text, small co-branded logo and slide number in the footer.
Charts & data	Sequence colours Confident Maroon → Brilliant Gold → Steel Grey → 10% maroon tint; label directly; avoid rainbow palettes and heavy gridlines. Where more series are needed, take them from SU's secondary palette (4.2.2), not from invented colours.
Emphasis	Gold used only as a thin accent (bars, underlines, single highlight), never as large fills of text.
Every deck	Carries the §7.2 disclaimer on a closing or notes slide when it presents Centre research.

7. Web & digital

The same identity carries to websites and other on-screen media. A maroon header and footer are not only permitted but characteristic of SU digital properties — su.ac.za and centre sites such as resep.sun.ac.za use maroon headers and footers. They express SU's 70%-maroon primary ratio and the first logo colourway (gold-and-white on Confident Maroon). Build the site as a Stellenbosch University site first, then apply the CHF descriptor.

Layout

- **Header:** a full-width Confident Maroon band with the **gold-and-white** co-branded logo at top-left and navigation in white (use one weight heavier when reversing type out of maroon, SU 4.3.2).
- **Footer:** a Confident Maroon band carrying the standard contact block and links in white or a light tint.
- **Content:** white or very light background with SU Black body text for readability; maroon headings, gold as a thin accent (rules, buttons, active states).
- **Links & buttons:** maroon or gold; avoid maroon or gold for long body text.

Assets & specs

- **Logo minimums (screen):** horizontal lockup ≥ **142 px** wide; portrait / stacked ≥ **85 px** high (SU 4.1.4). Use SVG so it stays crisp on all displays.
- **Colourways:** gold-and-white logo on the maroon header and footer; gold-and-maroon on white content areas; never place the logo on a clashing colour (SU 4.1.5).
- **Colour values:** maroon `#61223B`, gold `#CAA258`, body `#2C2A29`, neutral `#4D5356`, tint `#EFE9EB`.
- **Type:** SU Raleway as a licensed web-font; fall back to Trebuchet MS, then a system sans-serif. Keep ligatures off (`font-variant-ligatures: none`).

> **On "maroon headers and footers are off-brand".** They are not. Nothing in the SU Brand Manual restricts maroon to accents: colourway 1 (4.1.5) places gold-and-white on a maroon background, and the primary ratio (4.2.4) makes Confident Maroon the *dominant* colour — which is why SU's own sites use maroon headers and footers. Earlier CHF wording that framed maroon as a white-page accent was an editorial overstatement, not an SU rule; this version removes it.

8. Quick checklist

Before sending or publishing, confirm:

Logo & identity	Type, colour & layout
Official SU co-branded logo used, undistorted	SU Raleway (or Trebuchet fallback), ligatures off
Correct colourway for the background	Headings maroon; gold only as thin accents
Clear space (2× cap-height of “S”) and minimum size respected	Body text SU Black on white; leading = point size, or up to +2 pt
Logo placed top-left or bottom-left	Tables use maroon header + 10% maroon tint stripes
Standard contact block in the footer	No invented colours — every value traces to the SU manual
Maroon fields (header / footer / title) carry the gold-and-white logo	Web: logo ≥ 142 px / 85 px; SU Raleway web-font, ligatures off
§7.2 disclaimer present (author-attributed work)	Consistent file name & version

> **When in doubt, keep it plain.** A clean, well-typeset layout with the correct logo and maroon headings — whether on a white page or a maroon field — is always on-brand. Reach for the SU Brand Manual for anything these guidelines don’t cover, and ask SU Corporate Communication for artwork you don’t already have.

Centre for Household Finance · Brand & Document Guidelines · Version 1.2 · July 2026. Built on the Stellenbosch University corporate identity (Brand Manual, November 2025). Palette, minimum sizes, clear space, and typography per SU Corporate Communication and Marketing. Changes in v1.1: corrected Brilliant Gold CMYK; replaced the invented “Ink”, “Slate Grey”, and “Blush Tint” with SU Black, Steel Grey, and sanctioned maroon tints; corrected the clear-space rule and minimum sizes; Trebuchet as the fallback face; logo placement top-left or bottom-left; leading per SU. Changes in v1.2: corrected the maroon-usage guidance — Confident Maroon is the dominant colour and maroon headers, footers, title bands, and section blocks are on-brand (SU 4.1.5, 4.2.4); removed the earlier “not a background wash” framing; added a Web & digital section.